National Environment Agency
Safeguard · Nurture · Cherish

40 Scotts Road #13-00
Environment Building
Singapore 228231
www.nea.gov.sg

Ref: NEA-CMD-CIRCULAR-EPMA-00004-2022

Date: 1 September 2022

Designated Company Representatives, Registered Air-Conditioner and Refrigerator Suppliers under the Energy Conservation Act (ECA)

Dear Sir/Mdm

**UPDATE ON I) REQUIREMENTS UNDER THE ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AND MANAGEMENT ACT (EPMA) ON THE RESTRICTION IN SUPPLY OF REFRIGERATION AND AIR-CONDITIONING EQUIPMENT USING HIGH GLOBAL WARMING POTENTIAL (GWP) REFRGERANT AND II) DISCONTINUATION OF CLIMATE-FRIENDLY LABEL**

1 This circular is to update the industry on the following:

a) Restriction on the supply of regulated refrigerator and air-conditioning equipment that use high GWP refrigerants
b) Discontinuation of the Climate Friendly Label

**Restriction on the supply of regulated refrigerator and air-conditioning equipment that use high GWP refrigerants**

2 As a follow up to the circular (NEA-CMD-CIRCULAR-EPMA-00001-2021, dated 12 October 2021), please note that the following subsidiary legislations will come into effect on 1 October 2022. You may refer to the published regulations and orders in the links below:

a) Environmental Protection and Management (Greenhouse Gases) Regulations 2022
b) Environmental Protection and Management (Prescribed Regulated Goods) Order 2022
c) Environmental Protection and Management (Regulated Goods and Registered Suppliers) Regulations 2022
d) Environmental Protection and Management (Regulated Goods – Exemption) Order 2022

3 From 1 October 2022, companies supplying the regulated refrigerator and air-conditioning goods are required to hold a valid supplier registration with NEA and can only supply models of regulated goods that meet EPMA requirements (i.e. use refrigerant that meet the GWP limits and are registered with NEA). Any person found to be non-compliant shall be liable on conviction to a fine not exceeding $10,000.

4 Companies supplying regulated air-conditioners and refrigerators already registered under the ECA for Mandatory Energy Labelling Scheme (MELS) / Minimum Energy Performance Standards (MEPS) will be automatically considered registered under the EPMA and will not be required to register again.

5 Models of regulated air-conditioners and refrigerators already registered under the MELS/MEPS and meet the GWP limits will also be automatically considered registered under EPMA and will not be required to register again.

5 Suppliers will be given 1 year grace period, from 1 October 2022 to 30 September 2023, to clear the existing stock of non-compliant goods (imported or manufactured in Singapore before 1 October 2022). Regulated air-conditioner and refrigerator models registered under MELS/MEPS that do not meet the EPMA requirements will automatically have their certificate of registration (COR) revoked after 30 September 2023.

6 Suppliers can continue to use the existing Energy Labelling Scheme (ELS) online portal to register new regulated air-conditioner and refrigerator models for both MELS/MEPS and EPMA requirement under a single application.

**Discontinuation of Climate Friendly Label**

7 Following the implementation of the EPMA requirements, NEA will be discontinuing the use of the Climate-Friendly Label (CFL). Suppliers have up to 30 September 2023 to remove the CFL from their product (including advertisement). After 30 September 2023, there should not be any display of the CFL.

8 NEA would like to remind all that it is mandatory to affix the SCDF's advisory label on R32 air-conditioners and R600a refrigerators. Please refer to SCDF's latest circulars, here, for the requirements on affixing the advisory label.




*Figure 1: CFL for air-conditioners (left), CFL for refrigerators (middle), and SCDF Advisory Label (right)*

8 For any clarification, please contact Ms Jane Ng (email: Jane_Ng@nea.gov.sg) or Mr Gerald Tan (email: Gerald_Tan@nea.gov.sg).

Yours faithfully
(Transmitted via email)

Suresh K.
Director
Carbon Mitigation Division
National Environment Agency